



Fitdog Enrichment at Home

Fitness and Body Awareness Checklist



FITDOG TRAINING ACADEMY

Fitness and Body Awareness

Build body confidence safely.

A confident dog is not just mentally engaged. They are comfortable in their body, too.

Balance

Surfaces

Warm-up

Confidence

TRAINER NOTE

If your dog finishes puzzles instantly, increase difficulty slowly — or add sniffing.

Start here

Dog's name

Date

Owner

Best reward

Daily outlets

Sniffing, chewing, and problem-solving are needs — not extras.

Match difficulty

Enrichment should engage, not frustrate.

Track engagement

Fitness should build confidence, not push dogs past comfort or safety.

1 Training goal

YOUR GOAL THIS WEEK

Fitness should build confidence, not push dogs past comfort or safety.

2 Lesson focus checklist

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Safe movement | ☐ Balance exercises |
| ☐ Confidence with surfaces | ☐ Low-impact conditioning |
| ☐ Warmups and cooldowns | ☐ When to ask a vet |

Supplies needed

- Non-slip mat or book



FITNESS · TRACK

3 Step-by-step practice plan

SAFETY FIRST

Fitness builds confidence — not exhaustion. Stop for pain, limping, or fear.

Warm up with 30 seconds of slow walking or gentle movement indoors.

Practice one balance skill: front paws on a low book or platform for 3 seconds.

Guide your dog over a non-slip surface they are unsure about — treat for brave steps.

Cool down with calm sniffing or a chew for 2 minutes.

Note any hesitation or discomfort — stop and consult your vet if pain is suspected.

4 Session building blocks

Warm-up

30 sec gentle movement indoors

Balance

Front paws on low platform — 3 sec

Surfaces

Non-slip mat or new texture

Cool-down

Calm sniff or chew — 2 min

5 Weekly fitness log

Date	Exercise	Duration	Confidence 1-5	Notes
Day 1	Paws on book	3 sec	4	

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REVIEW • REFLECT

5 Common mistakes to avoid

AVOID THESE

- Using enrichment only when the dog is already destructive.
- Puzzles that are too hard — frustration, not fulfillment.
- Pushing balance exercises when your dog shows fear or pain.

If this happens, try this

IF THIS HAPPENS, TRY THIS

- Dog makes little progress — easier or use higher-value food.
- Dog loses interest after each session — tired, fulfilled.
- Refuses balance work — reward one paw on, not full pose.

6 Ready to progress?

- ☐ I can explain "Fitness and Body Awareness" clearly.
- ☐ I added at least one new enrichment activity this week.
- ☐ I ended sessions while my dog was still engaged.
- ☐ My dog had daily outlets for sniffing, chewing, or problem-solving.

Practice warm-up, one balance skill, and cool-down three times this week. Stop if you see pain or fear.

Where did my dog show confidence?

Where did they hesitate — and what made it easier?

Questions for my Fitdog trainer:

WELFARE / SAFETY

Stop if your dog shows pain, limping, or fear. Consult your vet before fitness work.